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■ **Additional passenger-focused features** include onboard Wi-Fi, sunshades for window seats, wall-mounted hooks for convenience, and dustbins placed across coaches to maintain cleanliness during travel.

SEE ALSO
P8-9

Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Universal health care system launched

DUBAI

BY SURABHI
VASUNDHARADEVI
Social Media Reporter

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has directed the adoption of a national health care system that guarantees comprehensive medical care and health services for all citizens. The system is underpinned by a fully integrated national health insurance scheme covering all emirates of the country.

The announcement reflects the leadership's commitment to ensuring universal access to high-quality health care for all citizens, and to building an advanced health sector grounded in preventive care, digital transformation, public health, innovation, and the long-term sustainability of health services.

The new system aims to develop a fully integrated health care model that enhances the efficiency and sustainability of health services, ensures the optimal utilisation of health care resources, and elevates sector readiness in line with international best practices and the highest global standards, affirming that human health is a fundamental national priority and a central pillar of the UAE's comprehensive development journey.

ISNR 2026

Abu Dhabi expands AI push into emergency response | P10

SPORT

IPL playoffs: 3 teams in, 5 more with a shot at fourth slot | P13



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*Brett Lee:
My kids are
learning
Arabic here*

DUBAI

BY MANJUSHA
RADHAKRISHNAN
Entertainment, Lifestyle
& Sport Editor

Former Australian fast bowler Brett Lee has praised the UAE's safety and lifestyle, saying recent regional tensions have only strengthened his belief that the UAE is "the safest place to be". Speaking candidly on *Gulf News' Dine With The Stars* podcast, Lee opened up about everything — from moving his family to Dubai and the pressures of IPL cricket to Bollywood, mental health and life after retirement.



"Over the last 12 weeks over here, a lot of people are texting saying, 'What's it like?'" Lee said during the podcast, adding that the situation only deepened his admiration for the UAE's leadership.

Lee, who recently met Dubai's ruler during the Dubai World Cup races, said he personally thanked him.

Calling Dubai home, Lee said: "This is the safest place to be. It is an incredible opportunity. It's an incredible place to live. My kids are learning Arabic." He added that they now attend school with "200 different nationalities".

SEE ALSO P15

DRONES THAT TARGETED BARAKAH CAME FROM IRAQI TERRITORY: UAE

Six hostile drones were intercepted over 48 hours

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE said yesterday that drones involved in the attack on the Barakah Nuclear Energy Plant were launched from Iraqi territory, as authorities warned the country reserved the right to take all necessary measures to protect its sovereignty and national security.

The Ministry of Defence said investigations into the May 17 attack confirmed that three drones linked to the incident originated from Iraq. Two were intercepted by UAE air defence systems, while a third struck an electrical generator outside the inner perimeter of the Barakah Nuclear Energy Plant in the Al Dhafra region, causing a fire.

The ministry added that six hostile drones targeting civilian and vital facilities across the UAE had been intercepted over the past 48 hours.

No casualties

In a statement, the ministry said the drones were detected, engaged and neutralised with "a high level of readiness and efficiency," stressing that no casualties were reported and there was no impact on critical infrastructure.

It also reaffirmed the armed forces' full readiness to respond to any threats targeting the country's security and strategic capabilities.

"The UAE reserves its right

ESCALATION

Trump warns of fresh strikes as Iran threatens 'new fronts'

WASHINGTON

President Donald Trump warned yesterday that the United States may strike Iran again, a day after he said he had held off a major assault in hope of a deal to end the war — but Tehran's army threatened to open "new fronts" if he went ahead.

Trump said that he had been just "an hour away" from re-launching Washington's attacks on Iran before postponing the order.

"You know how it is to negotiate with a country where you're beating them badly. They come to the table, they're begging to make a deal," he said.

"I hope we don't have to do the war, but we may have to give them another big hit. I'm not sure yet."

But Iran's army spokesman Mohammad Akraminia earlier warned the Islamic republic would "open new fronts against" the US if it restarted its attacks.

"I'm saying two or three days, maybe Friday, Saturday, Sunday, something, maybe early next week, a limited period of time," Trump said.

Trump's new deadline came after he said on Monday that the UAE, Saudi Arabia and Qatar had asked him to hold off on an attack at the 11th hour, which he did because "serious negotiations are taking place".

But if a deal was not agreed, he said he instructed the US military to be "prepared to go forward with a full, large-scale assault of Iran, on a moment's notice."

— AFP

to take all necessary measures to safeguard its sovereignty and national security, in line with international law," the ministry said.

The latest developments have intensified regional concerns

over the growing role of Iran-backed militias operating from Iraq amid the continuing conflict in the Gulf.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, warned of what he

described as dangerous ambiguity among some regional and international actors during the crisis.

In a post on X, Gargash said the "confusion of roles" during Iran's "treacherous aggression" was deeply alarming.

Blurred lines

"The roles of victim and mediator have become blurred ... and the friend has become a mediator instead of a supporter and ally," he wrote.

"In this most dangerous phase of modern Gulf history, the grey position remains more dangerous than outright inaction."

The UAE also renewed its condemnation of what it described as Iran's "illegal and unjustified attacks" against the UAE and neighbouring countries, including attempts to disrupt navigation in the Strait of Hormuz and target oil and gas infrastructure.

During a high-level international meeting on protecting energy flows and supply chains, the UAE, alongside partner nations, stressed the importance of respecting freedom of navigation and commercial shipping rights in accordance with international law and UN Security Council Resolution 2817.

The UAE also called for Iran to immediately halt efforts to obstruct maritime traffic in the Strait of Hormuz through the planting of sea mines and the imposition of what it described as illegal transit fees.

SEE ALSO P5, 11